

Certified Transcript of Vega Body-Worn-Camera Recording

Recording identifier: ACPD-BWC-236-20250203-195219 **Recording officer:** Priya Vega
Transcript prepared for filing: December 12, 2025 **Coverage:** arrival through medical request

This fictional transcript presents the material portion of Vega’s camera recording. Its purpose is to preserve the second angle without claiming that facing an event means seeing every hand movement. Brackets describe observable image or sound and deliberately refrain from resolving the disputed forearm strike, duty-belt reach, or pain-driven recoil.

19:52:19 — Video: Vega drives into the Larkspur Court parking area. Rusk’s marked vehicle is stopped ahead.

19:52:25 — Vega, to radio: Two-thirty-six arriving.

19:52:31 — Video: Vega parks. Iris Ellison stands near the lot edge and points toward Building C.

19:52:35 — Iris: She’s upstairs. She doesn’t have a weapon. Please be calm with her.

19:52:39 — Vega: Stay here and let us talk with her.

19:52:44 — Video: Vega walks behind Rusk toward the stairs. Her recording shows his back, the rail, and the upper breezeway.

The call remains a welfare event on radio. No criminal dispatch, threat, or weapon report is audible before contact.

Approach and initial exchange

19:52:48 — Video: From behind Rusk, Vega's frame shows Mara Ellison seated near C-12. Ellison's hands appear empty. Rusk asks her identity.

19:52:51 — Ellison: Yes. Why is everybody here? **Vega-source note:** Ellison is visible beyond Rusk's shoulder.

19:52:53 — Rusk: Your sister is worried. We're checking that you're safe. **Vega-source note:** Rusk remains between the lens and Ellison.

19:52:56 — Ellison: I told her I need space. I'm not going anywhere. **Vega-source note:** No movement toward the stairs is visible.

19:52:58 — Video: Vega stops several steps behind and left of Rusk. A vertical support partly separates her view of Ellison from the open walkway.

19:52:59 — Rusk: Are you hurt? Did you take your medication today?

19:53:00 — Ellison: That's between me and my doctor. Please back up. **Vega-source note:** The wider angle still shows the open walkway.

19:53:01 — Rusk: Stand up slowly and keep your hands where I can see them. **Vega-source note:** Contact has not yet begun.

The initial exchange is calm enough to understand, though Ellison's tone communicates distress and objection. The camera shows no weapon or assault. It cannot establish that no later danger developed. Vega's distance gives context but places Rusk between her lens and the hand nearest his body once he moves forward.

Physical restraint begins

19:53:02 — Video: Rusk reaches toward Ellison. From Vega's angle, his shoulder and arm partly block the contact point. Ellison's torso shifts.

19:53:03 — Ellison: Don't grab me. **Vega-source note:** Rusk's arm hides the wrist from this lens.

19:53:04 — Rusk: Hold still. Give me your other hand. **Vega-source note:** Vega begins closing distance.

19:53:05 — Video: Rusk and Ellison rotate. The rail, support, and Rusk's body prevent continuous identification of both hands. Vega starts forward.

19:53:06 — Ellison: Let go. That hurts. **Vega-source note:** The hand view is already intermittent.

19:53:07 — Rusk: Stop. Stop pulling. **Vega-source note:** Rotation continues behind Rusk.

19:53:07 — Vega: Mara, listen to one voice. I'm coming closer.

The image shows physical movement and Vega's approach. It does not show a clearly formed fist, a visible contact with Rusk's forearm, or a hand grasping equipment. It also does not preserve a continuous open-hand view that would exclude those events. The transcript therefore records only visible rotation and partial obstruction.

Vega later learned that Rusk identified the wrist grasp at 19:53:02 as the seizure's beginning. This transcript uses that time to align the two cameras. It does not treat the legal status of the seizure as a visual property or offer an opinion on the initial restraint's lawfulness.

Limited view — 19:53:08 through 19:53:13

19:53:08 — Video: Rusk’s back and shoulder cover the center. Ellison’s coat is visible beyond him. Her hands cannot be reliably located. The support occupies part of the side view.

19:53:09 — Sound: Foot and fabric noise. Speech overlaps.

19:53:10 — Rusk: Give me your hand. **Vega-source note:** Neither hand can be identified in this frame.

19:53:11 — Rusk: Stop pulling. **Vega-source note:** The command is clear while the central image is blocked.

19:53:11 — Ellison: You’re hurting me. **Vega-source note:** Her pain report follows without a visible hand path.

19:53:12 — Sound: A short contact noise occurs. Vega’s image does not reveal its source.

19:53:13 — Rusk: Hand behind you. Now. **Vega-source note:** His body remains the primary occluder.

19:53:13 — Video: Vega shifts left, but Rusk remains between her camera and the disputed hands.

The recording does not permit the contact sound to be labeled a strike. It also cannot rule one out. Rusk’s pulling description and Ellison’s pain complaint are both audible; neither supplies the unseen free hand’s path. Vega’s movement reflects an effort to obtain access and assist, not proof that she saw the alleged belt reach.

The visibility limit begins within the exact critical interval of 19:53:08–19:53:22. The second camera is continuous and authentic in this exercise, yet its angle is obstructed by the participants rather than by missing data.

Device sound and descent — 19:53:14 through 19:53:22

19:53:14 — Ellison: I can't—your hand—

19:53:15 — Rusk: Don't. Stay off it. **Vega-source note:** No object corresponding to “it” is visible.

19:53:15 — Vega: Nolan, I'm coming in. **Vega-source note:** Her approach steepens the camera angle.

19:53:16 — Sound: A continuous conducted-energy sound begins. Ellison cries out. Vega quickens her approach.

19:53:17 — Video: Rusk's torso still blocks the central contact. The camera angle lowers as Vega enters the confined area.

19:53:18 — Vega: Mara, go down. I'm on this side.

19:53:20 — Vega: I have space on this side. **Vega-source note:** The statement concerns access, not sight of a hand.

19:53:21 — Sound: The energy-device sound ends. Ellison says, “Stop, stop. I'm down.” **Vega-source note:** The frame remains partly blocked.

19:53:22 — Video: Ellison is at floor level. Vega reaches toward a visible forearm while Rusk remains opposite her.

The audio marks one cycle lasting about five seconds. It does not state why Rusk activated it. His “stay off it” phrase lacks a visible referent. Vega's view never clearly shows Ellison's hand on a belt or forearm during this span. Nor does it continuously show the hand elsewhere. The cleared frame at 19:53:22 is an aftermath view, not a reconstruction of the obscured seconds.

Handcuffing and immediate complaints

19:53:23 — Vega: Mara, bring this hand behind you. I'm on your right. **Vega-source note:** A forearm becomes visible after the critical interval.

19:53:25 — Ellison: My shoulder. Slow down. **Vega-source note:** The complaint is audible during hand positioning.

19:53:27 — Rusk: Stop moving and we can finish. **Vega-source note:** Both officers are now within the frame.

19:53:29 — Video: Vega controls Ellison's right forearm. Rusk is positioned on the other side. Ellison remains down.

19:53:31 — Vega: I have this hand. Easy. **Vega-source note:** Her own arms partly cover the wrist.

19:53:33 — Sound: A cuff ratchet is audible. Vega's arm partly blocks the wrist.

19:53:35 — Ellison: It burns. My wrist hurts. **Vega-source note:** No new device sound accompanies the complaint.

19:53:37 — Rusk: Cuffs are on. **Vega-source note:** The image stabilizes after this announcement.

19:53:42 — Vega: One person is going to talk. Mara, can you breathe okay? **Vega-source note:** She faces Ellison while speaking.

19:53:46 — Ellison: Yes. My shoulder and wrist hurt. **Vega-source note:** The response is clear and unoverlapped.

The camera shows partial hand control after the energy cycle. It contains no additional electronic activation or strike. Ellison's complaints are contemporaneous and later correspond to clinical evaluation, but the transcript does not diagnose injury. The visible movements involved in cuffing cannot establish the nature of movement before activation. Vega's use of a single-speaker approach reflects the welfare context and an effort to reduce distress after control.

Medical request, later statements, and certification

19:53:51 — Rusk, to radio: Subject restrained. Start medical for one drive-stun exposure.

Vega-source note: Rusk is partly outside this frame.

19:54:02 — Ellison: I never tried to take anything. I pulled because you hurt me. **Vega-source note:** This is a party statement, not a camera finding.

19:54:05 — Vega: Medical will check you. Stay with my voice.

19:54:12 — Video: Vega adjusts position to give Ellison more space while maintaining observation. The phone and keys are visible near the door.

19:54:25 — Vega, to radio: Confirm supervisor notification. No weapon located.

The remaining recording covers arrival of medical personnel and ordinary scene coordination. Vega does not announce that she witnessed a strike or reach, and she later states she could neither confirm nor exclude them. Ellison repeats her denial. The device history remains one cycle.

The fictional transcript preparer certifies that the December 12 exhibit follows the complete certified Vega working copy and labels only audible or visible content. No inaudible dialogue was invented. The transcript preserves the fact that Vega's angle does not reliably show Ellison's hands during the pivotal 19:53:08–19:53:22 interval.

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